

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Deputies Committee

DATE: August 23, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 3:35 p.m. - 6:25 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Deputies Committee Meeting on
Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

CHAIR

Sandy Berger

OMB

Phebe Vickers

Rodney Bent

OVP

Leon Fuerth

Richard Saunders

CIA

Dennis Blair

Norman Schindler

STATE

Strobe Talbott

James Steinberg

John Kornblum

Ralph Johnson

AID

Thomas Dine

Dalena Wright

DEFENSE

John White

Walter Slocombe

Jan Lodal

JCS

Wesley Clark

John Walsh

USUN

David Scheffer

(via secure video)

James O'Brien

NSC

Sandy Vershbow

Richard Clarke

Donald Kerrick

Stephen Flanagan

Summary of ConclusionsImplementation of a Bosnia Peace Settlement

1. Deputies met to finalize development of an integrated political/military plan for implementation of a Bosnian peace settlement. They reached agreement on several elements and tasked papers on several issues that require further analysis. These papers and a further and more detailed iteration of the OSD paper on the Peace Implementation Force (PIF) will be reviewed at another Deputies Meeting on Monday, August 28 (Action: OSD). ~~(S)~~

Deputies will also review a paper for Principals summarizing key recommendations and issues for decision (Action: NSC). ~~(S)~~

2. **Overall Concept:** Deputies agreed that our goal in implementing a settlement is to preserve Bosnia-Herzegovina as a single state comprised of two highly autonomous units. Our priority is to ensure the survival of the Bosniac-Croat Federation; this should be accomplished in the context of unity with the Bosnian Serb entity along with rights of association with Croatia and Serbia. ~~(S)~~

Deputies agreed that the Peace Implementation Force (PIF) should be deployed primarily (but not exclusively) in Federation territory. The operational commander should have broad authority for self-protection of the force and to enforce the cease-fire and separation of forces against incidents initiated by any party, using overwhelming force if necessary. At the same time, Deputies agreed the PIF should have defined limits on the scope of its responsibilities and operational conduct. The Deputies agreed that the response to massive violations of the agreement would be "evenhanded but asymmetrical." In the event of Bosnian Serb violation of the agreement, the PIF should be authorized to respond using air and ground forces, but this response should follow a ladder of escalation. In the event of serious Bosnian Government violation of the agreement, the PIF would withdraw. Deputies further agreed the PIF should not disarm the parties and that some tasks, such as demarcation of borders and resettlement of civilians, could be accomplished by civilian officials or agencies. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: State to draft brief overall mission statement for the PIF reflecting the limited tasks above. NSC to write a short paper identifying possible additional tasks for the PIF that may prove necessary, for example, if the settlement establishes a stronger central government or Bosnia-wide institutions. CIA to do an assessment of the Bosnian government's conception of a settlement and how this may alter the PIF's mission. OSD to do detailed mission statement as part of OSD paper. ~~(S)~~

3. **Gorazde:** Deputies noted that Principals, in light of Bosnian Government resistance to trading Gorazde for other territories, had requested an examination of the requirements for ensuring the viability of Gorazde if it remains part of the Federation under the terms of a settlement. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: DOD and CIA to assess implications for the PIF and the longer-term defense requirements for Gorazde following the departure of the PIF, using the Contact Group map as the baseline, but considering territorial improvements (e.g., larger corridor) as well. ~~(S)~~

4. Arms Limitations: Deputies agreed that our goal of establishing a stable military balance could best be achieved by a hybrid approach that would support enhancement of the self-defense capabilities of Federation armed forces (ABH and HVO) in tandem with efforts to reach agreement among all the parties to certain arms limitations or reductions. They agreed to separation zones (DMZs) and to examine inventory limits on CFE treaty limited equipment. They agreed that an arms control regime should have a regional context. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: State, in coordination with OSD, to develop detailed options for narrow DMZs, separation of heavy weapons and/or exclusion zones, overall limits on heavy weapons and confidence-building measures that could be included as part of the settlement and/or pursued following implementation of a settlement. ~~(S)~~

5. Exit Strategy: Deputies agreed that we need to establish a date certain for completion of the PIF mission. There was a consensus that the PIF should be terminated by the end of 1996. At the same time, we should identify mission-essential tasks that we would seek to complete prior to that date, although the PIF would withdraw whether or not all those tasks had been accomplished. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: State to draft an initial timeline paper defining political, economic and military benchmarks for accomplishment of critical tasks. CIA to do an assessment of how the parties would react to knowing there was a date certain. ~~(S)~~

6. National Participation/Funding: Deputies agreed that the PIF would be a NATO operation with limited non-NATO involvement. While there would be a UNSC resolution authorizing NATO to conduct the mission, there would be no dual key or other limitations on NATO command and control. Deputies agreed that no Ally should be excluded, but that the need for NAC consensus would force us to deal with Greek approval of Turkish participation. Deputies acknowledged that operational efficiency might be compromised by involvement of non-NATO forces but recognized that non-NATO participation will be politically necessary and, in some respects, desirable (e.g., as a proving ground for Partnership for Peace countries to operate with NATO forces). Non-NATO forces would be under NATO operational control similar to a CJTF. ~~(S)~~

On funding, Deputies agreed that we would seek to follow the normal NATO approach, i.e., NATO and other contributors would pay their own way, with common costs assessed according to a variant of the NATO infrastructure formula. Funding arrangements more

advantageous to the U.S. would be difficult to negotiate with our Allies, but will be explored. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: JCS/OSD to examine the political/military requirements and constraints of making the PIF a NATO-plus force, involving PFP partners and other non-NATO militaries. This should draw on previous NATO planning for implementation of the Vance-Owen plan (40103) and UNPROFOR extraction (40104). OSD/JCS to complete a cost estimate for the probable U.S. contribution to the PIF. The Peacekeeping Funding Group to reexamine alternative cost-sharing arrangements among the participants. ~~(S)~~

7. **Joint Commission:** Deputies agreed that a Joint Commission with local subsidiaries should be established (comprising NATO, the Federation and the Bosnian Serbs) to resolve problems in implementing the military aspects of a settlement. This might have national and regional components. Deputies also agreed that there would be other aspects of settlement implementation (political, economic, humanitarian) that could be beyond the purview of the Joint Commission, and that we needed to develop a concept for how these would be handled and whether there would be a senior Secretary General's Representative for NATO, the UN or, perhaps, the OSCE. They agreed that any arrangement should exclude interference with the operation of the PIF (i.e., no dual keys). ~~(S)~~

Tasking: State to draft a paper on the political analogue to the Joint Commission for implementing the non-military aspects of a settlement. ~~(S)~~

8. **Population Movements:** Deputies agreed that the parties should have primary responsibility for population movements, with international relief agencies (UNHCR) providing secondary support. The PIF should generally avoid involvement in population movements, but it should be prepared to protect UNHCR personnel, aid convoys, and refugees in transit as necessary. Deputies also agreed that restitution and other forms of compensation were alternatives to resettlement that we should encourage the parties to explore. ~~(S)~~

Tasking: State and USUN will do a paper on policy toward population movements, forced departures and associated enforcement mechanisms. ~~(S)~~

Post-War Reconstruction Assistance

9. Deputies agreed that we urgently need a conceptual framework and initial plan for post-war regional reconstruction, as well as rough estimates of the overall cost, and the preferred cost-sharing among the U.S., EU, Japan and Islamic countries. They

also expressed concerns about the difficulties of offsetting the U.S. contribution to the program on the basis of reductions in other programs. Deputies agreed that we would actively pursue the EU's offer to take the lead and press the EU, Japan and the Islamic states to clarify their contributions to the package. Deputies agreed that, in order to encourage Bosnian Government flexibility in the negotiations, Ambassador Holbrooke should be in a position by Monday to suggest the size of the U.S. contribution that the President will seek from the Congress in the event of a settlement (between \$500 million and \$1 billion over 3-5 years). They also agreed that we needed to inform the Congress immediately of our thinking on post-war reconstruction in the context of consultations on the progress of the U.S. diplomatic initiative. ~~(S)~~

Taskings: State to develop a post-war reconstruction program for the region, in coordination with NSC, OMB, AID and other agencies. State to draft talking points for a call by National Security Advisor Lake to Spanish Foreign Minister Solana to reconfirm the EU's willingness to take the lead on reconstruction and to offer the parties such carrots as EU association and enhanced market access. State and NSC to draft talking points for Holbrooke's use with the Bosnians on August 28. State and NSC to draft a gameplan and talking points for Congressional consultations August 26-28; these points should be in the context of an overall review of the status of the peace initiative and should also reference our commitment to participate in an implementation force if there is an agreement they will explain our goals and why solid U.S. financial backing is essential. ~~(S)~~

Sanctions

10. Deputies affirmed agreement on the main elements of our approach to sanctions relief for the FRY in the context of the U.S. diplomatic initiative: all UNSC sanctions, except those governing frozen assets subject to claims, would be suspended once there is a signed agreement; there would be a complete lifting of sanctions once implementation of the plan is completed; and Belgrade would receive less sweeping suspension of sanctions if it failed to agree to a solution for Eastern Slavonia at the time of signature. It was agreed that Deputies would need to decide at their next meeting how long we should hold Belgrade accountable for the actions of the Pale Serbs, and what would be the precise conditions for sanctions lifting. ~~(S)~~

Tasking: OVP to circulate a paper on a proposed sanctions strategy, highlighting the 4 or 5 fundamental issues needing Deputies' attention, including the sanctions reimposition mechanism and linkages to a Croatia settlement and war crimes, in preparation for the Deputies' meeting on August 28. ~~(S)~~

Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

This is not a presidential record. This is used as an administrative marker by the William J. Clinton Presidential Library Staff.

Documents from this Mandatory Declassification Review were released in full or released in part.

Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
